

Print Content (Canva-ready master copy, English)

Page 1 — Cover

- Title: JAPAN AUTUMN LEAVES (KOYO) TRIP PLANNER
- Subtitle: Chase the Fall Colors — A Flexible Plan You Can Time to Your Trip
- Footer line: This planner belongs to: _____

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Page 3 — About This Planner

- This planner helps you plan a fall-foliage trip and adjust it as forecasts update.
- Tip: foliage moves from north and high mountains toward lower, southern areas over several weeks. Build flexibility into your route.
- Note: peak dates shift each year. Confirm the latest forecasts and official details before you go.

Page 4 — Autumn in Japan: Overview

Field	Your notes
Travel window	From _____ to _____
Regions of interest	_____
Base areas / hotels	_____
Travelers	_____
Trip pace (relaxed / packed)	_____
Backup plan if colors are early/late	_____

Page 5 — How Foliage Timing Works

- Autumn color generally appears earlier in the north and in higher mountains, and later in lower-elevation and more southern areas.
- Within a single region, mountains and valleys can peak at different times, so a "miss" at one spot may be a "hit" nearby at another elevation.
- Cooler nights tend to bring out color; warm autumns can delay it. Weather, wind, and rain near peak can shorten the best window.
- Action steps:
 - ☒ Check current-year foliage forecasts for your regions
 - ☒ Note typical (not guaranteed) peak ranges as a rough guide
 - ☒ Keep one or two elevation/region alternatives ready
- Reminder: timing is never guaranteed — plan to enjoy the trip even if peak shifts.

Page 6 — Where to See Autumn Leaves (by region)

- General orientation only. Research current access, hours, and forecasts for each.

Region (general)	Why it's known for autumn	Rough timing tendency
Northern Japan / Hokkaido	Early color, mountains and parks	Tends earliest
Northern Tohoku	Mountain valleys, gorges, hot-spring areas	Early-mid
Central mountains / Japanese Alps	High peaks and plateaus	Mid, varies by elevation
Kanto & around the capital	Gardens, parks, temple grounds	Mid-late
Kansai (Kyoto area)	Temple gardens, hillsides, river valleys	Late
Western & southern Japan	Lower and milder areas	Latest

- Note: these are tendencies, not fixed dates. Always check the current-year forecast.

Page 7 — Suggested Flexible Route

Segment	Theme	Sample focus
Start	Higher / earlier colors	Mountain or northern area near peak
Middle	Mid-elevation gardens	Parks, plateaus, gorge or valley walks
End	Later / lower colors	Temple gardens or city parks, easy days

- Build the order around your dates and the latest forecast — go where color is peaking.
- Reminder: check opening days/hours, transport, and any reservation needs in advance.

Page 8 — Day 1 Plan

- Date: _____ Area focus: _____
- Morning: _____
- Afternoon: _____
- Evening: _____
- Foliage status seen (green / turning / peak / past): _____
- Meals / food to try: _____
- Transport notes: _____
- Notes: _____

Page 9 — Day 2 Plan

- (Same layout as Day 1.)
- Date / Area focus
- Morning / Afternoon / Evening
- Foliage status, meals, transport, notes

Page 10 — Day 3 Plan

- Date / Area focus
- Morning / Afternoon / Evening
- Foliage status, meals, transport, notes
- Flex box: If peak is elsewhere, alternative area _____ / how to get there _____

Page 11 — Foliage Timing & Weather Tracker

Spot / area	Forecast peak (check)	Status on my date	Weather	Worth it?
				[]
				[]
				[]
				[]

• Tip: re-check forecasts a few days before travel and again the night before — colors can move fast.

Page 12 — Photo-Spot Planner

Spot idea	Best light (am/pm)	Crowd level (check)	Shot in mind
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- Tips:
 - ☒ Early morning often means softer light and fewer people
 - ☒ Look for water, bridges, or temple roofs to frame leaves
 - ☒ Some sites hold evening illuminations in autumn — check current dates & tickets
 - ☒ Respect barriers and private areas; don't trample plants for a photo

Page 13 — Autumn Food Wish List

Dish / food	Where to try it	Tried?
		[]
		[]
		[]

- Ideas to research: chestnut sweets, sweet potato treats, mushroom dishes, persimmons, hot-pot meals, warm noodle dishes, seasonal sake, autumn fish.
- Tip: many small local shops prefer cash — keep some on hand.

Page 14 — Budget Tracker

Category	Planned	Actual
Accommodation		
Transport (rail / IC / buses)		
Food & drink		
Entries, gardens & illuminations		
Shopping & souvenirs		
Misc / buffer		
TOTAL		

- Note: autumn is a busy season; book ahead and check latest prices. Keep a buffer.

Page 15 — Autumn Packing Checklist

- Essentials

- ☒ Passport & copies
- ☒ Cards + some cash
- ☒ Booking confirmations
- ☒ Phone, charger, power bank
- ☒ Plug adapter
- ☒ eSIM / pocket Wi-Fi

- For cool, variable weather

- ☒ Warm layers (mornings and mountains get cold)
- ☒ Light jacket / fleece
- ☒ Rain jacket / compact umbrella
- ☒ Comfortable walking shoes
- ☒ Gloves / hat for high-elevation spots
- ☒ Small day bag

- Personal

- ☒ Medicine
- ☒ Reusable water bottle
- ☒ Camera / spare battery (cold drains batteries)

Page 16 — Useful Japanese Phrases

English	Japanese	Reading
Hello	こんにちは	konnichiwa
Thank you	ありがとう	arigatou
Excuse me / sorry	すみません	sumimasen
Are the leaves at peak now?	紅葉は今が見頃ですか	kouyou wa ima ga migoro desu ka
Where is a good autumn spot?	紅葉のおすすめはどこですか	kouyou no osusume wa doko desu ka
How much is it?	いくらですか	ikura desu ka
Where is the station?	駅はどこですか	eki wa doko desu ka
Check, please	お会計お願いします	okaikei onegai shimasu
Do you speak English?	英語を話せますか	eigo o hanasemasu ka
Help!	助けて	tasukete

Page 17 — Emergency Contacts

Contact	Number / detail
Emergency (police)	check local number on arrival
Emergency (fire / ambulance)	check local number on arrival
Your country's embassy	_____
Travel insurance hotline	_____
Card lost/stolen line	_____
Accommodation contact	_____
Home emergency contact	_____

- Tip: save these in your phone and keep a printed copy in your bag.

Page 18 — Trip Reflection

- Best foliage spot of the trip: _____
- Best meal: _____
- A place I'd return to (and when): _____
- Something I'd do differently: _____
- Overall rating: ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆